Viva Preparation Guide — Current 102-Case Thesis

This guide follows the current thesis PDF. The statistics companion teaches the statistical terms step by step. Historical answers for the earlier three-hypothesis model are kept in archive, not used for this viva.

Speak in the first person. Give the main answer first, then the number if asked. If you cannot remember a figure, say you will check the table; do not guess.

Rapid revision — read this first

- **Topic:** Employees' perceptions of one recent Union Bank programme combining digital and face-to-face learning.
- **Model:** Hybrid Learning (HL), Trainer Competence (TC), and Learner Engagement (LE) are **three separate independent variables**. They jointly predict perceived Training Effectiveness (TE), the dependent variable. LE is **not** a tested mediator.
- **One hypothesis:** H_0 says the three predictors do not jointly predict TE; H_1 says they do.
- **Questionnaire:** 30 questions: four eligibility/profile questions and 26 rating items (HL 7, TC 6, LE 6, TE 7). Union Vidya is context within HL, not a fifth variable.
- **Collection:** 132 main responses (70 paper, 62 online); 29 screened out (16 No, 11 unconfirmed eligibility, two incomplete profiles); 103 profile-complete (54 paper, 49 online). SPSS used **102** valid cases for the main regression.
- **Pilot:** 20 eligible online responses on 15–16 September 2026, separate from the main data. Main collection began on 15 September in parallel.
- **Main result:** $F(3, 98) = 50.652$, $p < .001$, $R^2 = .608$. **Reject the overall H_0; support H_1 for the three predictors together.** Only LE was individually significant ($\beta = .532$, $p < .001$). HL ($p = .096$) and TC ($p = .346$) were not individually significant in that joint model.
- **Other key results:** Means: HL 4.148, TC 4.158, LE 4.317, TE 4.254. The lowest HL item was digital preparation before face-to-face learning (Q6, mean 3.990). The saved SPSS reliability output gives **one alpha, .980, for all 26 items together**, not four final-sample alphas. HL and TC were strongly related ($r = .818$).
- **Limits:** Selected Chennai context, self-reported answers at one time, no causal or Bank-wide claim. The saved SPSS output does not give a VIF number.
- **Practical suggestions:** Give preparation early, connect digital material to trainer-led practice, protect time for questions, and review what employees found hard. These are suggestions, not tested fixes.

Opening answers

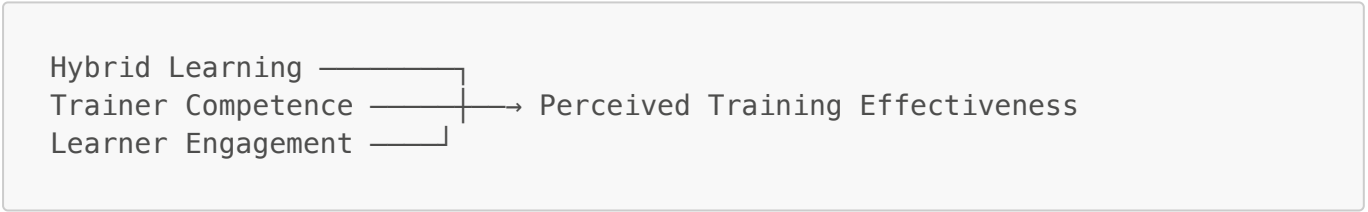
30-second introduction

> I studied how Union Bank employees in the Chennai context experienced one programme combining digital and face-to-face learning. I asked whether Hybrid Learning, Trainer Competence, and Learner Engagement together were related to perceived Training Effectiveness. I received 132 main responses; 103 were profile-complete, and the main SPSS regression used 102 valid cases. The overall model was significant, but only Learner Engagement was individually significant after the three predictors were considered together.

Two-minute explanation

> Banking employees need to learn new procedures and digital systems while continuing their daily work. Union Bank has digital resources, including Union Vidya, as well as trainer-led learning. I wanted to hear how employees experienced one recent programme that combined those parts.
>
> My questionnaire measured four ideas: how the digital and face-to-face parts worked together, how the trainer supported learning, how actively the employee engaged, and how useful the employee felt the training was. The first three were independent variables; perceived Training Effectiveness was the dependent variable. The survey had 30 questions. I collected both paper and online responses and screened them for eligibility and complete profiles.
>
> The three independent variables together had a significant relationship with perceived Training Effectiveness among the 102 valid SPSS cases. The model accounted for 60.8% of the differences in effectiveness scores in that sample. Learner Engagement had the clearest separate association; Hybrid Learning and Trainer Competence did not have individually significant coefficients after all three entered together. Employees rated digital preparation before the face-to-face session lowest among the Hybrid Learning items. I therefore suggest reviewing preparation, the connection between modes, and opportunities to participate. These are employee perceptions and associations, not proof that a particular change causes better performance.

Model I can draw



Learner Engagement is a **separate predictor**. Even a well-designed programme and a capable trainer do not ensure that every employee can engage; workload, time, interest, and other conditions can matter. The study did not measure all those outside conditions or test a mediation path.

Likely Viva Questions and Answers

A. Topic, problem, gap, and contribution

1. What is your study about?

Say: I studied whether employees who rated Hybrid Learning, Trainer Competence, and Learner Engagement more positively also rated their Training Effectiveness more positively when those three predictors were considered together.

Remember: Three independent variables jointly predicting one dependent variable.

If asked further: I asked about one recent programme with both digital and face-to-face learning; I did not compare online-only with classroom-only training.

2. Why did you choose this topic?

Say: Bank employees need to learn changing procedures and systems while continuing daily work. I wanted to understand how the learning arrangement, trainer, and employee participation relate to perceived usefulness of training.

Remember: Practical HR and learning-and-development question.

If asked further: My study evaluates employee perceptions, not technical performance of the learning platform.

3. What do you mean by “hybrid learning”?

Say: Hybrid learning is a planned programme in which digital learning and face-to-face learning support each other. For example, employees may complete digital preparation, attend a trainer-led discussion or practice session, and revisit digital material later.

Remember: Connected modes, not simply two modes existing in the same programme.

If asked further: The right balance can differ by topic; my study does not prescribe one fixed ratio.

4. What is the research problem?

Say: Union Bank has digital and trainer-led learning infrastructure, but that does not show whether employees experience a particular programme as connected, supported, engaging, and useful in their work. Published evidence on all four of these constructs together in a public-sector banking context is limited.

Remember: Infrastructure does not automatically show employee-level effectiveness.

If asked further: My study fills an employee-experience gap, not a Bank-wide performance gap.

5. What research gap does the study fill?

Say: The gap is at the intersection of hybrid learning, trainer competence, learner engagement, and training effectiveness among public-sector bank employees. Much blended-learning research is from higher education, while the Indian banking study I used focuses on training effectiveness without studying hybrid learning or Union Vidya.

Remember: Workplace gap + banking gap + mechanism gap + measurement gap.

If asked further: I do not claim that no related research exists. I claim the evidence is limited and fragmented at this specific intersection.

6. How is your study useful to Union Bank?

Say: It provides structured employee feedback on programme connection, trainer support, engagement, and perceived training usefulness. It identifies practical areas that the learning-and-development team can review.

Remember: It suggests review areas, not guaranteed solutions.

If asked further: The recommendations are based on the response pattern and should be tested before any Bank-wide implementation.

7. What is original in your research?

Say: The originality is the focused four-construct employee-perception study in the Union Bank Chennai context, with Union Vidya treated as the digital-learning context. The study combines corporate hybrid-training literature with Indian banking training-effectiveness literature.

Remember: Originality comes from the focused context and combination, not from claiming a new universal theory.

If asked further: The questionnaire is literature-informed and adapted; it is not presented as a globally validated new scale.

8. Is this a study of training effectiveness or a study of Union Vidya?

Say: It is primarily a study of employee experience of hybrid learning and training effectiveness. Union Vidya is the Bank's LMS and is included as part of the digital-learning context within Hybrid Learning.

Remember: Union Vidya is context, not a fifth scored construct.

If asked further: A separate LMS study would require questions on system quality, uptime, technical support, analytics, and user satisfaction.

9. Why is this relevant to HRM?

Say: HRM is concerned with employee development, capability, and the design of learning opportunities. This study examines conditions that may help employees take part in learning and apply relevant knowledge in their current roles.

Remember: Training design and trainer support are HR/L&D concerns.

If asked further: The study does not measure financial performance or customer outcomes.

10. What is the main message of the research?

Say: Employees rated all four areas positively. The three predictors were significant together, but engagement had the clearest separate association with perceived effectiveness. That makes participation and preparation useful areas for the Bank to review.

Remember: Overall result and individual result are different questions.

If asked further: The data suggest review areas; they do not prove a particular intervention will work.

B. Union Bank context and base papers

11. Why did you choose Union Bank of India?

Say: Union Bank is a suitable setting because its public reports describe both digital-learning resources and trainer-led learning arrangements. The Chennai South context also gave me access to eligible employees who had attended relevant programmes.

Remember: Suitability came from documented infrastructure and feasible employee access.

If asked further: I do not claim that every Union Bank programme is hybrid.

12. What is Union Vidya?

Say: Union Vidya is identified by Union Bank as its Learning Management System. The Bank's reports describe it within a wider system of e-learning, virtual learning, role-based learning, mandatory modules, and a Training Management System.

Remember: It is the Bank's LMS/LXP context.

If asked further: Respondents could have used Union Vidya or another authorised platform for their selected programme.

13. What evidence shows that hybrid learning is relevant at Union Bank?

Say: The annual reports describe digital resources, virtual workshops, e-learning, staggered programmes, and trainer-led learning. The Bank also has Union Learning Academies and Staff Training Centres. A 2026 staff circular gives an example of selected trainer-led sessions being live-streamed through Microsoft Teams with recordings available through Union Vidya.

Remember: This establishes organisational context, not employee-level results.

If asked further: My survey was needed because organisational documents cannot show how individual employees experienced a programme.

14. Why did you use three base papers instead of one?

Say: No single accessible paper covered hybrid learning, corporate training, Indian banking, trainer competence, learner engagement, training effectiveness, and a suitable instrument together. The guide permitted up to three base papers with a clear justification, so I selected complementary papers rather than forcing one paper to cover claims outside its scope.

Remember: Conceptual + corporate + banking roles.

If asked further: Supporting literature was also used for questionnaire wording and theoretical interpretation.

15. What is the role of Sosnova et al. (2025)?

Say: Sosnova et al. is the conceptual base paper. It studies hybrid education methods and learning effectiveness among students. It supports the broad idea that a carefully designed hybrid approach can be examined in relation to learning outcomes.

Remember: Student study; conceptual anchor only.

If asked further: I do not present it as direct evidence about Union Bank employees.

16. What is the role of Kim (2022)?

Say: Kim is the main corporate hybrid-training paper. It studies automotive sales training across traditional, fully digital, and hybrid delivery. It shows why training design, instructor involvement, practice, and employee perceptions should be evaluated.

Remember: 583 training instances; corporate setting.

If asked further: Kim did not prove that hybrid is always better than classroom training, so I do not make that claim.

17. What is the role of Bahl, Kiran and Sharma (2024)?

Say: Bahl et al. is the Indian banking anchor. It studied 402 managerial and non-managerial bank employees using Kirkpatrick's training-evaluation framework. It shows that employee-level training effectiveness is a substantive issue in the banking sector.

Remember: Indian banking; 402 employees; Kirkpatrick framework.

If asked further: It does not study hybrid learning or my complete model. Its role is specifically to support the banking relevance of training effectiveness.

18. Why is Bahl relevant if it does not study hybrid learning?

Say: My study has two linked areas: hybrid-learning experience and training effectiveness. Bahl is relevant to the second area because it provides open, India-specific banking evidence that training effectiveness can be evaluated among bank employees. Kim provides the corporate hybrid-training side, while Bahl provides the banking training-effectiveness side.

Remember: Do not overstate Bahl's scope.

If asked further: The model was built through compatible evidence from several sources, not copied from Bahl.

19. Did you copy a model from one base paper?

Say: No. The four-construct model was developed from the combined literature. Sosnova supports the hybrid-learning/effectiveness idea, Kim supports corporate training design and instructor involvement, and Bahl supports banking training-effectiveness evaluation.

Remember: Complementary literature, transparent adaptation.

If asked further: The model is designed for the present research question and sample, not claimed as a replication.

20. Why did you not use a bank-specific hybrid-learning paper as the only base paper?

Say: I could not identify an accessible paper that simultaneously had a banking population, hybrid learning, training effectiveness, trainer competence, learner engagement, and suitable measurement items. Using three papers with separate justified roles was more academically honest.

Remember: Lack of one perfect source was documented.

If asked further: The questionnaire evidence map records the supporting basis for the item areas.

C. Model, objectives, and variables

21. Which variables are independent and dependent?

Say: Hybrid Learning, Trainer Competence, and Learner Engagement are my three independent variables. Perceived Training Effectiveness is the dependent variable.

Remember: HL + TC + LE → TE.

If asked further: Union Vidya is part of the digital-learning context within HL, not a separate scored variable.

22. Why did you choose four constructs instead of two?

Say: The earlier two-variable idea was easier, but it left out the trainer and the employee's participation. Four constructs let me study those distinct parts while keeping one manageable regression model.

Remember: Three predictors and one outcome.

If asked further: The model treats engagement as another predictor, not as a proven step between the other variables and effectiveness.

23. Why did you not use knowledge retention or job performance?

Say: Knowledge retention and job performance need different evidence, such as delayed testing, supervisor ratings, work records, or performance measures. Adding them would have widened the questionnaire and encouraged claims that the present cross-sectional self-report data could not support.

Remember: Scope matched data and design.

If asked further: They are valid topics for a future longitudinal study.

24. Why is Trainer Competence separate from Hybrid Learning?

Say: HL asks how the digital and face-to-face parts worked together and whether material was accessible. TC asks whether the trainer explained, connected, encouraged, and gave feedback. They can be related without measuring the same thing.

Remember: Programme arrangement and trainer behaviour have different item wording.

If asked further: They were strongly correlated (r = .818), so I read their separate regression coefficients cautiously.

25. Why is Learner Engagement a separate predictor?

Say: An employee may fail to engage even with a well-planned programme and a capable trainer because of workload, limited time, interest, or other conditions. I therefore measured the employee's own participation separately and entered it beside HL and TC as a predictor of perceived TE.

Remember: LE is independent in this regression, not a mediator.

If asked further: The study did not measure all outside influences or prove what caused an employee to engage.

26. What is your main objective?

Say: My main objective is to examine whether HL, TC, and LE jointly predict perceived TE among eligible Union Bank respondents.

Remember: One joint regression objective.

If asked further: I also described ratings for the four constructs and their pairwise associations.

27. What is your hypothesis?

Say: I have one overall hypothesis. H_0 says HL, TC, and LE do not jointly predict TE. H_1 says they do. The main regression tested this question.

Remember: One overall H_0/H_1 pair, not three separate relationship hypotheses.

If asked further: Individual coefficient results help interpret the model but are not three extra hypothesis decisions.

28. Why do you include a direct HL-to-TE relationship?

Say: In my final model, HL, TC, and LE all enter the regression directly as predictors of TE. This lets me test one clear joint relationship without assuming an untested causal chain.

Remember: All three arrows point to perceived TE.

If asked further: A formal mediation model would be a different study with a different analysis plan.

29. Did you test mediation?

Say: No. I did not estimate an indirect effect or show that HL and TC work through LE. I tested one model in which all three are predictors of TE.

Remember: No formal mediation claim.

If asked further: The variables are correlated, but correlation does not establish a causal sequence.

30. What ideas from theory support the study?

Say: Blended-learning work explains why the two delivery modes should connect; trainer and engagement literature explains why guidance and participation matter; training-evaluation work explains why employee learning and usefulness should be measured.

Remember: Literature supports the chosen questions and constructs, not a proven causal path.

If asked further: The three base papers have different roles and none is claimed to test this exact four-construct model.

D. Questionnaire and measurement

31. How did you develop the questionnaire?

Say: I used a literature-informed, researcher-adapted questionnaire. The wording was based on the selected base papers and supporting measurement literature, then adapted to the Union Bank employee-training context and reviewed by the academic guide.

Remember: Literature-informed and guide-reviewed.

If asked further: It is not presented as a ready-made or fully validated Union Bank scale.

32. How many questions are in the questionnaire?

Say: There are 30 numbered questions. Questions 1 to 4 cover eligibility and respondent profile. Questions 5 to 30 are 26 five-point Likert-scale items.

Remember: 4 profile/eligibility + 26 scored items.

If asked further: The response scale runs from 1, Strongly Disagree, to 5, Strongly Agree.

33. How are the 26 items divided?

Say: Hybrid Learning has 7 items, Trainer Competence has 6, Learner Engagement has 6, and Training Effectiveness has 7.

Remember: 7 + 6 + 6 + 7 = 26.

If asked further: Each construct score is the arithmetic mean of its assigned items.

34. What sources supported the Hybrid Learning questions?

Say: The Hybrid Learning items were informed by blended-learning integration literature and workplace evidence, especially Han and Ellis on blended-learning environment perceptions and Mulaudzi on workplace access, flexibility, materials, and facilitation.

Remember: Connected design, access, navigation, availability, revision.

If asked further: The wording was changed from student language to employee-training language.

35. What sources supported the Trainer Competence and Engagement questions?

Say: Kim supports the relevance of instructor involvement, participation, practice, and training design. Mulaudzi supports workplace facilitation and access. Engagement literature supports attention, effort, interest, participation, and clarification-seeking.

Remember: Trainer actions and employee participation were measured separately.

If asked further: No selected base paper offered the exact full workplace scale for these two constructs; this limitation is stated openly.

36. What sources supported Training Effectiveness questions?

Say: Kim supports perceived competence, job-skill relevance, and training evaluation. Bahl provides the Indian banking training-effectiveness context through Kirkpatrick’s framework. Aziz supports employee-

level training effectiveness without requiring organisation-level outcomes.

Remember: Understanding, relevance, capability, application, confidence.

If asked further: I did not include Bank productivity or financial results because respondents cannot validly measure them through a short self-report survey.

37. Why did you use a five-point Likert scale?

Say: A five-point agreement scale is simple for busy employees to understand and complete. It provides enough variation for descriptive statistics, reliability testing, correlation, and regression analysis.

Remember: 1 = Strongly Disagree; 5 = Strongly Agree.

If asked further: A longer scale was unnecessary for a short paper-and-online workplace questionnaire.

38. How did you define eligibility?

Say: A respondent had to have attended at least one programme in the previous 12 months that included both digital or online learning and face-to-face learning. Each respondent answered about one such programme.

Remember: Q1 = Yes was required for inclusion.

If asked further: Employees who attended only digital or only face-to-face training could not answer meaningfully about the connection between modes.

39. Why did you mention Union Vidya in the questionnaire?

Say: Union Vidya was named as an example of Union Bank’s digital learning platform to make the questions understandable in the Bank context. The wording also allowed another authorised platform because not every selected programme had to use identical systems.

Remember: Example platform; no assumption of identical access.

If asked further: I did not ask technical system-performance questions because this was not an LMS evaluation.

40. Did you conduct a pilot study?

Say: Yes. I ran a separate online pilot with 20 eligible employees from 15 to 16 September 2026. Main-study collection also began on 15 September, using the same guide-approved questionnaire. The pilot checked clarity and burden, but it did not lead to changes in the scored questions. Pilot responses were kept out of the main analysis.

Remember: The pilot and main collection overlapped at the start; do not say the pilot was completed first.

If asked further: Because the main survey had already begun, pilot feedback could not be used to revise the first main questionnaires. The pilot was small and online only; a larger independent validation study could test the instrument further.

E. Sample and data collection

41. Who was your population?

Say: The population was Union Bank employees connected with the Chennai South Regional Office and related branch-level collection points who had attended a recent programme combining digital and face-to-face learning.

Remember: Chennai context; eligible employees only.

If asked further: The study does not claim to represent the full national Union Bank workforce.

42. What sampling method did you use?

Say: I used purposive sampling. I approached employees who met the study's eligibility condition and were available through the Chennai South Regional Office, associated locations, branches, paper forms, and the Google Forms link.

Remember: Eligibility-based non-probability sampling.

If asked further: This was appropriate because the study required respondents with relevant hybrid-training experience.

43. Why did you use purposive sampling rather than random sampling?

Say: Random sampling would include employees who may not have attended a relevant hybrid programme. Purposive sampling allowed me to collect responses from employees who could answer the study questions meaningfully.

Remember: Relevance of experience was essential.

If asked further: The trade-off is limited statistical generalisation, which I state as a limitation.

44. How did you collect data?

Say: I collected data through 70 printed questionnaires and 62 Google Forms submissions. Paper responses were collected through Chennai South Regional Office, associated points, and branches. The Google Form enabled participation when employees could not complete a physical form during workload periods.

Remember: 70 paper + 62 online = 132 received.

If asked further: Both modes used the same approved questionnaire.

45. Why did you use both paper forms and Google Forms?

Say: Using both modes made participation practical for employees with different workload conditions and access situations. The questionnaire content and scoring were the same in both modes.

Remember: Wider participation without disrupting branch work.

If asked further: Digital records were reconciled against the original Google Forms export; paper records were manually verified.

46. How many responses did you receive and analyse?

Say: I received 132 main responses: 70 on paper and 62 online. Screening left 103 profile-complete records, comprising 54 paper and 49 online. The main SPSS regression used 102 valid cases because one case lacked a TC mean in that SPSS file.

Remember: 132 received → 103 profile-complete → 102 in main SPSS model.

If asked further: The pilot's 20 online responses are separate and are not part of these counts.

47. Why were 29 main records screened out?

Say: Sixteen respondents answered No to the eligibility question, eleven paper forms did not establish eligibility, and two otherwise eligible forms lacked required profile information. Those 29 records were excluded before the 103 profile-complete records were prepared.

Remember: 16 + 11 + 2 = 29.

If asked further: The additional SPSS listwise exclusion is separate: it reduced the main model from 103 to 102.

48. How did you ensure ethical data collection?

Say: Participation was voluntary. The questionnaire did not collect names, confidential Bank information, customer information, or other personal identifiers. Responses were used only for academic analysis and reported in combined form.

Remember: Voluntary, anonymous, academic use.

If asked further: I obtained verbal permission from the HR Manager for academic data collection.

F. Data cleaning and analysis

49. What data cleaning did you do?

Say: I retained only Q1 = Yes responses, checked that all retained records had the 26 item fields, checked values were within the permitted 1 to 5 range, reconciled online records against the original workbook, and documented any unclear paper-form responses.

Remember: Structural checks, reconciliation, eligibility screening.

If asked further: Repeated anonymous response patterns were noted but retained because similarity alone does not prove duplicate respondents.

50. Was any unclear paper mark retained in the active data?

Say: The active 103-record scored file has one documented response-coding decision for an unclear paper mark. That answer is recorded as a valid whole-number category. An earlier decision concerned a form later excluded because its profile was incomplete.

Remember: One active response-coding decision; a separate SPSS case lacked a TC mean.

If asked further: The matching SPSS case file was unavailable, so I do not claim a row-by-row reconciliation between its 102 cases and the separately selected scored file.

51. Why use the within-construct rule for that one active item?

Say: The retained paper form had one unclear scored item and was otherwise complete. The documented rule used the respondent's other answers in the same construct to choose the nearest valid 1–5 category.

Remember: A limited, recorded scoring decision; not a general rule for filling many answers.

If asked further: A record with multiple unclear scored items would not be handled this way.

52. What does Cronbach's alpha check?

Say: It checks whether answers across a set of questionnaire items move consistently together. The saved final SPSS output reports this check for all 26 rating items as one combined set.

Remember: Consistency does not prove that each construct is perfectly measured.

If asked further: The four separate pilot alphas were preliminary and must not be presented as four final-sample SPSS results.

53. What reliability result does the saved SPSS output report?

Say: It reports one Cronbach's alpha of .980 for all 26 scored items together, using 102 valid cases. The 20-person pilot gave preliminary block alphas from .879 to .929.

Remember: One final pooled alpha, not four final construct alphas.

If asked further: A very high pooled alpha may reflect overlapping questions and does not by itself validate the four constructs.

54. Why report Pearson correlations?

Say: Correlations show whether two scores tended to rise together. I used them to describe the pairwise relationships among the four construct averages before interpreting the combined regression.

Remember: Six positive significant pairs; the main hypothesis is the joint regression.

If asked further: Pairwise correlations use 102 or 103 available cases, depending on which scores were needed.

55. Why is regression the main test?

Say: My hypothesis asks whether HL, TC, and LE together predict perceived TE. Multiple regression examines that joint relationship and shows each predictor's separate coefficient when the other two are included.

Remember: One model, three predictors, one outcome, 102 valid cases.

If asked further: The significant overall model does not mean all three individual coefficients are significant.

56. What about predictor overlap and VIF?

Say: HL and TC were strongly correlated at r = .818, so their separate roles in the regression are harder to distinguish. VIF is a diagnostic that could assess overlap, but the saved SPSS regression output did not report a VIF value.

Remember: Do not quote a VIF number: the saved SPSS regression did not report one.

If asked further: Predictor overlap is a possible explanation for non-significant separate coefficients, not a proven sole cause.

57. Did you use SPSS?

Say: Yes. The saved SPSS Statistics 23 output contains the main 102-case regression, correlations, overall 26-item alpha, exploratory PCA, descriptives, and other checks. The thesis also labels supplementary tables made from a separately selected 102-record scored file.

Remember: Name the source of each result; the two 102-case sources were not verified as the same people.

If asked further: The matching SPSS case file was unavailable, so I do not claim exact person-by-person agreement with the supplementary file.

G. Findings, strategies, limitations, and future research

58. What are your main findings?

Say: All four construct averages were above the neutral point. The three-predictor regression was significant overall, with $R^2 = .608$. Of the three predictors, only LE was individually significant after they entered together. Q6, about digital preparation before the face-to-face session, was the lowest HL item at 3.990.

Remember: Overall model significant; LE individually significant; preparation worth review.

If asked further: The findings describe employee perceptions in this selected sample, not causal effects.

59. What exactly did the regression show?

Say: For 102 valid SPSS cases, the overall model was significant: $F(3, 98) = 50.652$, $p < .001$, $R^2 = .608$. I rejected the overall H_0. LE had $p < .001$ individually; HL had $p = .096$ and TC $p = .346$, so those two were not individually significant at .05.

Remember: One overall hypothesis decision, three coefficient descriptions.

If asked further: R^2 describes differences in reported TE scores within this sample; it is not a percentage of training caused by the predictors.

60. What practical suggestions follow from your findings?

Say: I suggest giving digital preparation early, connecting it explicitly to trainer-led activities, making time for questions and practice, and asking employees which part of the programme was difficult. These are review points because LE stood out in the model and Q6 had the lowest HL mean.

Remember: Recommendations are proposals, not proven interventions.

If asked further: The Bank would need to test any change before assuming it improves outcomes.

Final reminder

> Among 102 valid SPSS cases, HL, TC, and LE jointly predicted perceived TE, so I rejected the overall null hypothesis. LE was the only individually significant predictor after all three entered the model. My recommendations concern participation and digital preparation, but the survey does not prove causation or represent the whole Bank.

Hard Cross-Questions: Direct Defence Answers

These questions are more likely when the guide tests the boundaries of the study. Answer them calmly and directly. A limitation stated honestly is more credible than an overclaim.

Challenge 1. You use “hybrid learning” and “blended learning.” Are they different?

Say: In much of the literature, hybrid learning and blended learning are used for the planned combination of digital and face-to-face learning. I use **Hybrid Learning** consistently as the name of my construct. The important point in my study is that the two modes are connected as parts of one programme.

Remember: The terminology varies; the construct definition is clear.

If asked further: I did not treat the terms as two separate variables.

Challenge 2. Sosnova’s study is about Ukrainian students. Why is it acceptable in a workplace bank study?

Say: Sosnova is not used as direct evidence about bank employees. It is the conceptual base paper because it examines whether a carefully designed hybrid approach can be related to learning effectiveness. I combine that conceptual evidence with Kim’s corporate training evidence and Bahl’s Indian banking training-effectiveness evidence.

Remember: Conceptual role only; no claim of direct transfer from students to bank employees.

If asked further: The present data were collected from Union Bank employees, so the findings are based on the workplace sample rather than on the student study.

Challenge 3. Why did you use an automotive sales-training paper for a bank study?

Say: Kim is relevant because it examines workplace training, not because automotive sales and banking are identical. It supports the corporate-learning principles of programme design, instructor involvement, practice, participation, and evaluation. Bahl supplies the Indian banking training-effectiveness context.

Remember: Corporate learning principle from Kim; banking context from Bahl.

If asked further: I do not claim that a result from automotive sales automatically applies to banking.

Challenge 4. What proof do you have that your research gap is real?

Say: The literature shows four connected gaps. First, much blended-learning research is based on students rather than workplace employees. Second, Bahl studies training effectiveness in Indian banking but does not study Hybrid Learning, Trainer Competence, Learner Engagement, or Union Vidya. Third, the selected base papers do not test my four-construct employee-experience model together. Fourth, available measures could not be transferred unchanged into a short Union Bank employee questionnaire.

Remember: Workplace, banking, mechanism, and measurement gaps.

If asked further: I describe the gap as limited and fragmented evidence, not as an absence of all related research.

Challenge 5. Why correlation and regression rather than SEM?

Say: The final thesis asks one joint prediction question. Pearson correlations describe pairs, and multiple regression tests the three predictors together. SEM and formal mediation would need a more demanding design and fuller measurement validation than this project provides.

Remember: One regression model; no path or mediation test.

If asked further: The cross-sectional survey cannot establish the order in which experiences occurred.

Challenge 6. Why did you choose a cross-sectional design?

Say: I used a cross-sectional survey because the study aimed to describe employees' current recalled experience of one recent hybrid-training programme within the available dissertation fieldwork period. It was feasible for branch employees and suited the focused relationship questions.

Remember: Feasible snapshot of reported experience.

If asked further: It cannot establish what came first or prove cause and effect. A future pre-training and post-training study would be stronger for that purpose.

Challenge 7. Are 102 regression cases enough for your model?

Say: The main model has three averaged predictors and 102 valid SPSS cases. That supports a modest regression analysis within this selected sample, but I do not claim full scale validation, SEM, or Bank-wide representation.

Remember: 102 main-model cases; 103 profile-complete before SPSS.

If asked further: I also report the predictor overlap and self-report limits rather than treating sample size alone as proof of validity.

Challenge 8. Why did you study Chennai South only, rather than several regions?

Say: The study was scoped to the Chennai South fieldwork context because that was where I had access to eligible employees through the Regional Office, associated locations, and branches. This allowed direct data collection within the available academic period.

Remember: Defined fieldwork scope and access.

If asked further: This is why I limit the findings to the selected Chennai-context respondents and do not generalise to all regions.

Challenge 9. What was your response rate?

Say: I cannot calculate a formal response rate because no complete count of everyone approached or invited was kept across paper visits and the shareable online link. I can report 132 received, 29 screened out, 103 profile-complete, and 102 valid cases in the main SPSS model.

Remember: Do not invent an invitation denominator.

If asked further: A future study should keep an invitation log.

Challenge 10. How did you get permission to collect data in the branches?

Say: Verbal permission was obtained through the HR Manager for academic data collection. The questionnaire did not request personal identifiers, customer information, or confidential Bank data.

Remember: Verbal HR permission; academic purpose; no sensitive data.

If asked further: I do not claim that I had written permission, because the permission recorded for this study was verbal.

Challenge 11. Could paper forms and Google Forms have biased the results?

Say: It is possible that collection mode influenced participation because employees with different work schedules or digital comfort may have selected different modes. Both modes used the same approved questionnaire and scoring rules, and online records were reconciled with the original export. I did not separately test mode differences, so this remains a limitation.

Remember: Same instrument; mode bias was not tested.

If asked further: The study reports the two modes transparently: 70 paper submissions and 62 Google Forms submissions.

Challenge 12. How did you verify the paper-form responses?

Say: The paper questionnaires were treated as source records and manually transcribed into structured response records. Eligibility and scored responses were checked from the forms. Blank or illegible eligibility responses were excluded. The one unclear-item coding decision in the active scored file is recorded in the data-quality audit.

Remember: Paper source record, manual verification, documented exceptions.

If asked further: Of 70 received paper forms, 54 passed the active eligibility and profile checks. The active audit records the retained response-coding decision.

Challenge 13. How do you know that similar answers were not duplicate responses?

Say: I do not know with certainty from anonymous forms alone. Similar answer patterns were checked and recorded, but I retained them because identical or similar responses do not prove that the same person responded twice. Removing them without identifying evidence would create another form of bias.

Remember: Similarity is not proof of duplication.

If asked further: The questionnaire did not collect names, because anonymity was part of the ethical approach.

Challenge 14. Your overall alpha is .980. Is the questionnaire repetitive?

Say: That value shows the 26 items moved closely together in the saved SPSS output. It could also reflect some overlap among items. Because it pools all four areas, I do not treat it as four separate reliability results or proof of full validity.

Remember: One pooled final alpha of .980; four preliminary pilot block alphas .879–.929.

If asked further: Future work can examine items and test the scales in an independent sample.

Challenge 15. HL and TC correlate at .818. Are they really different?

Say: Their scores are strongly related, but the questions cover different ideas: HL asks about integration and digital access; TC asks about trainer explanation and support. The overlap makes their separate regression coefficients harder to interpret.

Remember: r = .818 in the saved SPSS table; no VIF value reported there.

If asked further: I do not claim that their distinction has been fully validated or that overlap alone explains the coefficient results.

Challenge 16. What is common-method bias, and how does it affect your study?

Say: Common-method bias means that the same person answered all the variables in the same questionnaire at one point in time. This can make correlations appear stronger because the response style is shared. My findings may therefore reflect both real reported associations and some common-method influence.

Remember: Same respondent, same time, same survey.

If asked further: A future study can combine employee responses with knowledge tests, supervisor observations, system records, or data collected at different times.

Challenge 17. Why did you use five response options instead of seven?

Say: A five-point scale was selected because it is easy for busy employees to understand and complete in both paper and Google Forms. It provides enough response variation for the planned descriptive and relationship analysis without making the questionnaire longer or more difficult.

Remember: Clarity and practicality for field respondents.

If asked further: A seven-point scale is also valid in other studies; I chose five points for this short workplace instrument.

Challenge 18. Did you use reverse-coded questions? Why not?

Say: No. I kept all statements direct and positively worded so that the paper and online questionnaire would be easy to understand across employees and would reduce confusion during quick completion. The absence of reverse-coded items is a design limitation because agreement-style response tendencies may remain.

Remember: Clarity was prioritised; acquiescence bias remains possible.

If asked further: A future instrument can test carefully worded reverse items after piloting them with the target employee group.

Challenge 19. Why was Hybrid Learning lowest among the four means?

Say: HL still had a favourable average of 4.148; it was only the lowest relative to the other three means. Its lowest item was digital preparation before face-to-face learning, at 3.990, which gives a concrete area to review.

Remember: HL 4.148; Q6 3.990; both are above neutral 3.

If asked further: A lower relative mean does not show that hybrid learning failed.

Challenge 20. If engagement was highest, what remains to improve?

Say: LE had the highest mean, 4.317, but averages can hide differences between employees and items. LE was also the only individually significant predictor in the joint regression. The Bank can review whether employees have enough time and opportunity to participate, ask questions, and practise.

Remember: LE 4.317; engagement result is an association, not an intervention effect.

If asked further: A wider study could test workload, manager support, and later application with independent evidence.

Mock Viva — 15 Questions to Practise Aloud

This is a practice conversation using the **current** one-hypothesis thesis. Answer the first question in one or two sentences. Give the follow-up only if the examiner asks for more. The detailed answers above and the statistics companion provide the background.

1. What did you study?

Student: I studied how employees experienced one Union Bank programme combining digital and face-to-face learning. I tested whether Hybrid Learning, Trainer Competence, and Learner Engagement together related to their perceived Training Effectiveness.

If asked whether this proves causation: No. I collected one-time self-reports, so I can describe associations only.

2. Why does the topic matter to HR?

Student: Bank employees must keep learning changing procedures and digital systems while serving customers. HR can use employee feedback to review preparation, trainer support, and opportunities to participate.

If asked about benefit: The recommendations are areas to test, not proven improvements.

3. What is your research gap?

Student: Research exists on hybrid learning and on bank training effectiveness, but the evidence is fragmented for these four employee-perception constructs together in an Indian public-sector bank context.

If challenged: I do not claim that no related research exists.

4. Why three base papers?

Student: Sosnova gives a conceptual hybrid-learning starting point, Kim supplies corporate training evidence, and Bahl supplies Indian banking training-effectiveness evidence. None alone covers my full question.

If challenged about Sosnova's student sample: I use it for the concept, not as direct evidence about bank employees.

5. Explain your model.

Student: HL, TC, and LE are three independent variables entered together. Perceived TE is the dependent variable. LE is a separate predictor, not a tested mediator.

If asked why engagement is separate: Even with good design and a capable trainer, workload or limited time may affect participation.

6. What is Union Vidya's place in the study?

Student: It is Union Bank's learning-platform context within Hybrid Learning. I did not score it as a fifth variable or evaluate its technical performance.

If asked whether all respondents used it: The questionnaire allowed another authorised platform for the selected programme.

7. How was the questionnaire built?

Student: The 30-question instrument was adapted from the selected papers and supporting measurement literature, reviewed by my guide, and checked in a separate small online pilot. It has four eligibility/profile questions and 26 rating statements.

If asked about scale validation: I do not claim a fully validated new scale.

8. When was the pilot?

Student: Twenty eligible employees completed the separate online pilot on 15–16 September 2026. Main collection began on 15 September in parallel. Pilot responses were not included in the main analysis.

If challenged about overlap: The same guide-approved scored questions were used; the pilot did not lead to wording changes during main collection.

9. How many responses were analysed?

Student: I received 132 main responses. Twenty-nine were screened out, leaving 103 profile-complete records. The saved SPSS regression used 102 valid cases because one case lacked a TC average in that file.

If asked about modes: The 103 profile-complete records comprised 54 paper and 49 online responses.

10. Why purposive sampling?

Student: Employees needed recent experience of both digital and face-to-face learning to answer about their connection. I therefore selected eligible respondents rather than a random group of all Bank employees.

If asked about generalisation: My sample cannot statistically represent the entire Bank.

11. What reliability result do you have?

Student: The saved final SPSS output reports one alpha of .980 for all 26 scored items together. It does not give four separate final-sample construct alphas.

If asked about the pilot: Its four preliminary block alphas ranged from .879 to .929, but they came from only 20 pilot responses.

12. What did the main hypothesis test show?

Student: The joint regression was significant: $F(3, 98) = 50.652$, $p < .001$, with $R^2 = .608$. I rejected the overall null hypothesis for the three predictors together.

If asked what R^2 means: The model accounted for 60.8% of the differences in perceived TE scores among these 102 cases, not 60.8% of training caused by the predictors.

13. Were all three predictors individually significant?

Student: No. LE was significant at $p < .001$. HL had $p = .096$ and TC $p = .346$, so neither had a separately significant coefficient after all three entered the model.

If challenged: HL and TC are still relevant parts of the model and had positive pairwise relationships; there are no separate hypotheses to reject for them.

14. What is the most useful practical finding?

Student: LE had the clearest separate association with perceived effectiveness. Among HL questions, digital preparation before the face-to-face session was lowest, although still positively rated, with a mean of 3.990.

If asked for action: I would review whether staff receive usable preparation early enough and have time to ask questions and practise.

15. What is your honest conclusion?

Student: The three predictors jointly related to perceived TE in this selected Chennai-context group, and engagement stood out after adjustment. The findings can guide a review of hybrid training, but they do not prove causation or describe every Union Bank employee.

If asked what you would do next: I would include more regions, collect data at different times, and add independent learning or work-application measures.